Diagnosing Phase

The diagnosing phase involves a nurse making an educated judgment about a potential or actual health problem with a patient. Multiple diagnoses are sometimes made for a single patient. These assessments not only include an actual description of the problem (e.g. sleep deprivation) but also whether or not a patient is at risk of developing further problems. The diagnoses phase is a critical step as it is used to determine the course of treatment.

"A plan is a list of actions arranged in whatever sequence is thought likely to achieve an objective."

-John Argenti

The nurse looks over Sanjay's symptoms and notes that his heart-rate is higher than average and his blood pressure is elevated. She also considers that he's experienced fatigue and shortness of breath. The nurse determines that Sanjay is experiencing high levels of cholesterol, which is having high levels of fat within the blood. The nurse is also concerned that Sanjay is at risk for heart disease.



Planning Phase

Once a patient and nurse agree on the diagnoses, a plan of action can be developed. If multiple diagnoses need to be addressed, the head nurse will prioritize each assessment and devote attention to severe symptoms and high risk factors. **Each problem is assigned a clear, measurable goal** for the expected beneficial outcome.

Apprehension, uncertainty, waiting, expectation, fear of surprise, do a patient more harm than any exertion.

-Florence Nightingale

The nurse sits down with him in a closed room and explains his cholesterol levels and high blood pressure. She suggests that Sanjay be put on medication to help lower these blood levels and recommends him to do exercise at least twice a week. The nurse also tells Sanjay he should stay away from salty foods and eat less red meat. Sanjay agrees with the nurse, and they set up a follow-up appointment two weeks later. The nurse reminds Sanjay to call or visit the hospital immediately if there is any changes in his condition, or if he starts to feel worse.



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